NORTHEASTERN UNIVERSITY



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Module 3 Project

CLASS NUMBER - ALY 6080

CLASS – Integrated Experiential Learning

CRN NUMBER – 70242

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ACADEMIC YEAR – FALL 2025

COMPLETION DATE – 05TH October, 2025

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Annotated Bibliography (Article 2)

Ucar, K., Jovanovic, M., & Vogiatzis, C. (2022). Analyzing and predicting success of professional musicians. *Scientific Reports*, *12*, 19123. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-022-25430-9

This article explores how machine learning algorithms can predict the success of professional musicians using data from Spotify and Musicbrainz. The authors employed XGBoost regression models, decision trees, and support vector machines, achieving 82% accuracy in predicting genre-specific success outcomes. The study identifies four key predictors: average popularity scores, productivity metrics (release frequency and consistency), collaboration network strength, and genre classification patterns. The research demonstrates that successful prediction requires multi-dimensional analysis combining artistic output, audience engagement, and strategic networking behaviors.

These insights align closely with the XN Project's aim to develop a Creator Success Analytics Platform for YSSL's creative residency program. The research emphasizes that collaboration networks and productivity patterns are crucial for understanding creator development. The study's multi-dimensional approach offers guidance on evaluating creative professionals across different artistic disciplines consistently. Using this framework will help YSSL create an analytics platform that promotes evidence-based decision-making and resource allocation for identifying high-potential residents.

Swan, P., & Atkinson, S. (2012). Managing evaluation: A community arts organisation perspective. *Arts & Health*, *4*(3), 217-229. https://doi.org/10.1080/17533015.2012.665372

This article examines how community arts organizations balance their creative ethos with external evaluation demands from funders and stakeholders. The researchers conducted a year-long ethnographic study involving twenty semi-structured interviews with staff and participants from an arts and health organization in the United Kingdom. Key findings reveal that while staff recognized evaluation as necessary for accountability and funding, they viewed it as time-consuming and potentially threatening to organizational values. The study identifies three primary evaluation challenges: satisfying multiple stakeholders with competing priorities, community-level rather than individual-level changes. Successful organizations negotiated evaluation terms with funders rather than passively accepting imposed frameworks, developing alternative evidence methods including visual documentation and participant narratives.

These findings directly inform the XN Project's Creator Success Analytics Platform for YSSL by highlighting the importance of designing evaluation systems that respect creative work while meeting accountability needs. Swan and Atkinson's framework for negotiated evaluation offers practical guidance for building the platform with input from artists, program administrators, and community stakeholders from the design phase. Their identification of alternative evidence methods provides options for capturing qualitative dimensions of creator success that complement quantitative metrics, ensuring the platform measures both artistic development and program outcomes without compromising the creative residency experience.